

Helen L. Kissel

CONTACT INFORMATION	Stanford Department of Economics 57 Jane Stanford Way Stanford, CA 94305	+1(978) 821-7645 hkissel@stanford.edu www.helenkissel.com
EDUCATION	Stanford University , Stanford, CA Doctor of Philosophy, Economics University of Toronto , Toronto, ON Master of Arts, Economics Doctoral Stream Colorado College , Colorado Springs, CO Bachelor of Arts, Mathematical Economics	2019-Present 2016-2017 2012-2016
ACADEMIC REFERENCES	Ran Abramitzky Professor of Economics Stanford University ranabr@stanford.edu Petra Persson Professor of Economics Stanford University perssonp@stanford.edu	Maya Rossin-Slater Professor of Health Policy Stanford University mrossin@stanford.edu Heidi Williams Professor of Economics Dartmouth College heidi.lie.williams@dartmouth.edu
WORKING PAPERS	Understanding Variation in Cesarean Section Use: Supply-Side Drivers and Maternal Health Effects (Job Market Paper) <i>with Helena Roy</i> We estimate the causes and consequences of regional variation in healthcare utilization in the setting of Cesarean sections (C-sections), the most common inpatient surgery in the United States. C-section rates differ up to 10-fold across hospitals, with substantial variation even for clinically similar patients. Using nationwide Medicaid administrative claims data, covering 42% of all US births, we leverage physician mobility across hospitals to disentangle the role of physician practice style from hospital environment. We find that differences in physician practice style can explain over one quarter of the across-hospital differences in C-section rates. This variation in practice style has meaningful consequences for patient health: low-risk patients quasi-randomly assigned to more C-section-intensive physicians are 10% more likely to deliver via unplanned C-section, leading to worse maternal health outcomes without measurable improvements in infant health. Our findings highlight physician practice style as an important driver of variation in obstetric care with direct consequences for maternal health. Patient Mix and Provider Experience: Racial Disparities in US Maternal Health <i>with Helena Roy</i> Maternal mortality in the United States is two to three times higher than in most other high-income countries, with stark racial disparities. One potential avenue for reducing racial disparities is through physician training that addresses patient heterogeneity by race. In this paper, we examine whether racial disparities in treatment use and outcomes can be traced back to physicians' OB/GYN residency training, as reflected in the practice patterns of their alumni. We find that residency programs have only modest effects on treatment use and outcomes across racial groups. Notably, a residency's relative effect on C-section use and delivery complications is not strongly correlated across Black versus White patients, suggesting non-uniform learning across different patient groups. We also examine if training at a residency with a more diverse patient mix, a feature advertised by multiple residencies as an important part of physician education, impacts physicians' deviation from clinical consensus in delivery decisions. Though we document that deviations from clinical consensus are more likely for Black patients, we find essentially no impact of training with a diverse patient population on this racial gap.	

SELECTED RESEARCH IN PROGRESS	Birth Centers and Maternal and Infant Health <i>with Ambar La Forgia, Petra Persson, Maya Rossin-Slater and Helena Roy</i>	
	Willingness to Pay for Concordance in Health Care <i>with Tamri Matiasvili and Helena Roy</i>	
	Shell-Shocked: Long-Run Consequences of Wartime Stress <i>with Boaz Abramson</i>	
RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIPS & INTERNSHIPS	Cause Prioritization Intern , Open Philanthropy	2022
	Report on tobacco control.	
	Research Assistant for Daniel Fetter , Stanford Economics	2021-2022
	Research Assistant for Heidi Williams , Stanford Economics	2020
TEACHING ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE	Predoctoral Research Fellow for Ran Abramitzky and Leah Boustan Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research Code and documentation webpage.	2017-2019
	Stanford University Department of Economics:	
	ECON 155: Environmental Economics and Policy	Fall 2021, Winter 2023
	ECON 144: Family and Society	Winter 2022
	ECON 113: Historical Perspectives on Inequality and Opportunity in America	Spring 2022
	ECON 15Q: The Economics of Immigration in the US	Winter 2018
	University of Toronto:	
	Undergraduate Microeconomic Theory	Winter 2016, Spring 2017
GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS, & AWARDS	Ely Graduate Fellow , Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research	2025
	Shultz Research Grant , Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research	2024
	Centennial Teaching Assistant Award , Stanford University	2023
	Spectrum Pilot Grant , Stanford Center for Population Health Sciences	2022-2023
	Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award , Stanford Economics Department	2021, 2022, 2023
	Stanford Graduate Fellowship in Science & Engineering	2019-2022
	University of Toronto Fellowship	2016-2017
MENTORSHIP & DEPARTMENT SERVICE	Phi Beta Kappa , Colorado College	2016
	Teaching Assistant Coordinator , Stanford University	2023-2025
	BING Honors College Graduate Student Mentor , Stanford University	2024, 2025
	Economics Honors Thesis Mentor , Spelman College	2021-2023
	Wellness Information Network Representative , Stanford Economics	2021-2023
ADDITIONAL INFORMATION	Graduate Student Social Chair , Stanford Economics	2020-2021
	Citizenship: United States and Canada	